

OGUST CONVENTION

ABOUT THE DEALS

You will always be in the South position. Either you or partner may open the bidding.

The first page (or two) of each Deal shows only your hand. The initial bidding is given and you are asked to decide what you would bid, then click the word **BID** up in the bidding table. The next page will then appear showing the recommended bid and continuing the auction. On the final page of each Deal partner's hand will be shown.

ABOUT OGUST

First let's review the "standard" bidding which follows a Weak 2-bid opening.

If the Responder has an interest in going higher he bids 2NT.

The Weak-2 opener replies as follows:

- With a minimum, rebid the suit at the 3-level
- With a maximum, show a feature (Ace or King) of an outside suit by bidding that suit at the 3-level
- With a solid suit (A K Q x x x) bid 3NT

If you are happy with that method just stop reading this and go over to the Weak 2-bid topic for some practice!

Ogust rebids:

As the popularity of Weak 2-bids has increased, the requirement for suit quality has declined. Many of today's players ignore the old requirement that you should have 2 of the top 3 honors, (or 3 honors altogether) in the suit.

A hand like ♠ 5 ♥ Q 9 8 6 5 3 ♦ A 7 3 ♣ 9 6 2 might be opened 2♥ by an opponent.

Or, you might fall under the spell and open 2♥ with the hand yourself.

Harold Ogust developed a convention to allow Responder to obtain more information from the Weak-2 opener. The Ogust Convention also starts with Responder bidding 2NT, but Opener's rebids are more descriptive.

OPENER REBIDS AFTER OGUST 2NT		
3♣	minimum hand	poor suit
3♦	minimum hand	good suit
3♥	maximum hand	poor suit
3♠	maximum hand	good suit
3NT	A K Q x x x suit	

In theory, once the Responder learns which of the five categories Opener falls into he should be able to set the contract correctly.

Of course it is important that the partners are agreed on the meanings of minimum/maximum and poor/good.

Here are our suggestions:

Assuming your Weak 2-bid strength is 6-11 total points, use 6-8 as minimum, 9-11 as maximum.

A good suit is headed by any two of the top three honors (A K Q) a poor suit is not.

That's all there is to it. The 10 Practice Deals are worth 10,000 more words.

Board: 1
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥K

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦7

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣Q

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥K

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 7 5 4

♥ J 6 3 2

♦ J 10

♣ K Q 5

♠ A 9 3

♥ A 7 5

♦ K 6 5 4

♣ A 8 2



♠ K J 8

♥ K Q 10 9

♦ 2

♣ J 10 9 6 3

♠ 10 6 2

♥ 8 4

♦ A Q 9 8 7 3

♣ 7 4

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

3♦

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥K

You could just guess between pass, 3NT, or 5♦.

But you use Ogust instead. Partner responds 3♦.

Partner's 3♦ bid shows a minimum hand but a good suit, which should mean two of the top three honors. Your ♦K tells you that partner has a 6-card ♦ suit headed by the A Q. With three outside Aces you can count 9 tricks - you bid 3NT.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 3

♥ 10 2

♦ A K Q 10 6 4

♣ 9 8 4

♠ Q 6 2

♥ K 9 7 5 4

♦ 9 8 3

♣ J 10

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 9 4

♥ A 6 3

♦ J 2

♣ A K 7 6

♠ A 10 7 5

♥ Q J 8

♦ 7 5

♣ Q 5 3 2

Having opened 2♦, you reply to partner's Ogust 2NT bid with 3NT, showing a ♦ suit headed by A K Q. Partner passes.

West

2♦

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♦7

North

Pass

East

2NT

South

Pass

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 9 8 7 6 5

♥ 6

♦ 8 2

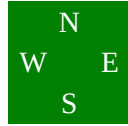
♣ Q J 10 3

♠ Q 10 3

♥ 7 5

♦ A K Q 4

♣ A 8 7 2



♠ K J 4

♥ J 9 4 2

♦ J 10 9 3

♣ K 5

♠ 2

♥ A K Q 10 8 3

♦ 7 6 5

♣ 9 6 4

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♣Q

This is a perfect hand for Ogust - when you're not sure what to do! So you bid 2NT. Partner responds 3NT.

Partner's 3NT bid describes his hand exactly;

♥ A K Q x x x and nothing else. You **MIGHT** have a ♠ stopper, but they might be arranged so the defenders could take the first 5 ♠ tricks. So you bid the "safe" 4♥ game which depends only on a 3-2 trump split.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 3
♥ A Q 9 7 6 4
♦ 8 5
♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q J 10 2
♥ J 10 8
♦ Q 6 2
♣ K 10 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8 7 6
♥ K 5
♦ A 9 7 4
♣ A 8 6

♠ 9 5 4
♥ 3 2
♦ K J 10 3
♣ Q J 5 4

After opening 2♥ you reply to partner's Ogust 2NT with 3♠, showing a maximum hand along with a good suit. Partner bids 4♥ and you pass.

West	North	East	South
2♥	Pass	2NT	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			
4♥ by West			
Lead: ♠Q			

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

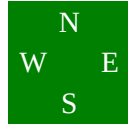
♠ 6
 ♥ Q J 10 4
 ♦ J 10 8 6
 ♣ Q 9 6 5

♠ A Q 9 8 7 4

♥ 8 7 3

♦ 7 5

♣ K 4



♠ J 5 2

♥ A K 9 6 2

♦ 3 2

♣ J 10 3

♠ K 10 3

♥ 5

♦ A K Q 9 4

♣ A 8 7 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

6♠ by North

Lead: ♥K

Before you read this lesson you might have just jumped to a Blackwood 4NT. But now you bid an Ogust 2NT. Partner rebids 3♠.

Wow! Partner has a maximum Weak 2-bid and a good trump suit, no doubt headed by the A Q. If he also has the ♥A you might be cold for 7♠. Bid Blackwood if you must, but you don't really need to since partner could not possibly have The ♥A **AND** ♠ A Q x x x. Too many points for a Weak 2-bid. So you bid 6♠.